ACCESSIBLE DESIGN

TIPS FOR GRAPHIC DESIGNERS

Be Accessible®

What is accessible web design?

Accessible web design provides a website that all users can navigate, understand, and interact with regardless of their abilities.

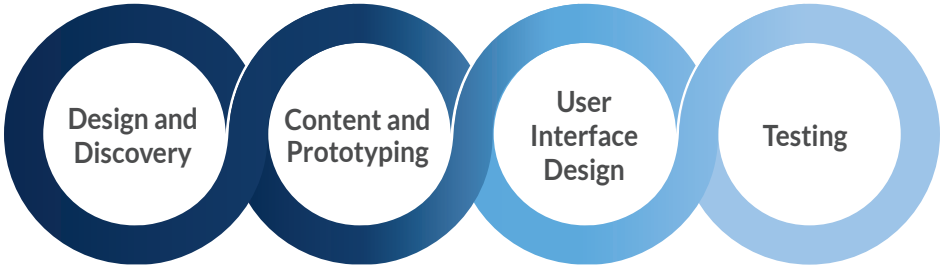
According to the **W**eb **C**ontent **A**ccessibility **G**uidelines (WCAG) provided by the **W**orld **W**ide **W**eb **C**onsortium (W3C), an accessible website is perceivable, operable, understandable, and robust.

Who is responsible for creating accessible websites?

Each designer has an important role during development to ensure accessible results. Working together, designers ensure web content is accessible to people with a variety of abilities.

The tables on the following pages define what each designer is responsible for providing, when they should be included in the development process, and how their expertise impacts accessibility.

Example of a four-stage development process:



How do I use WCAG?

Web accessibility testing involves an extensive step-by-step process of manual evaluation and is best achieved during the development phase of a website.

WCAG's four principles include testable success criteria that are divided into three levels of conformance: Level A, Level AA, and Level AAA. Each level is defined based on a set of success criteria.

You can find WCAG online at https://www.w3.org/TR/WCAG21/

Is WCAG Enough?

Although WCAG is extensive, real users testing is required to confirm a website's accessibility. Include disabled users in your web accessibility testing process.

If your development team needs accessibility training, contact Be Accessible. We will provide the guidance needed to ensure your website is accessible to everyone.

Be Accessible®

Who, What, When, and How of Accessible Web Design

(Who) Provider	What they provide	When it's provided	How they provide accessibility
Graphic Designer	Accessible graphic prototypes	• Design & discovery • Content development and prototyping	• Provides guidance to decision makers on accessible colors and consistent layouts • Provides prototypes that will set the standard for an accessible interface
Content Designer (Copywriters)	Clear language with descriptive links and understandable content structure	• Design & discovery • Content development and prototyping	• Provides guidance for using clear and descriptive language • Provides content that allows the use of semantic HTML such as headings, lists, and tables
User Interface (UI) Designer	Accessible HTML, CSS, JavaScript, and other coding	• All Phases	• Provides guidance on what can and cannot be accomplished with accessible code • Provides all coding accessibly • Adjusts coding after UX testing is complete
User Experience (UX) Designer	User experience feedback from people with a variety of abilities	• UI Design • Final Testing	• Performs testing with and without assistive technology such as screen readers • Provides feedback to designers to ensure a positive experience for all users regardless of abilities

ACCESSIBLE DESIGN

TIPS FOR GRAPHIC DESIGNERS

Be Accessible®

Graphic Designers

Graphic designers define the visual appearance of a website and strongly impact the accessibility of the final product. Graphic designers trained in accessibility provide prototypes that are both aesthetically appealing and inclusive to the widest variety of users.

DO	DON'T	WHY
A use sufficient color contrast	A use low color contrast	People with low vision and various color dependencies require a certain level of color contrast to distinguish content from its background.
DOWNLOAD GUIDE ensure color contrast and distinguishable elements in all link states	DOWNLOAD HERE use low color contrast and/or eliminate hover/focus effects in link states	People depend on hover and focus states to navigate active elements such as links and buttons. All active, hover, focus, and visited states must be accessible.
Sale Today use text styles that can be accomplished with CSS	Sale Today create designs that require images of text instead of HTML	Text within images will not increase in size when someone applies text-only zoom and can lead to pixilation.
use a combination of color and shape to convey information	convey information using only color	It is difficult for people with visual color deficiencies to understand content presented with only color. Assistive technology such as screen readers can not perceive shape.

ACCESSIBLE DESIGN

TIPS FOR GRAPHIC DESIGNERS

Be Accessible®

Graphic Designers

Graphic designers define the visual appearance of a website and strongly impact the accessibility of the final product. Graphic designers trained in accessibility provide prototypes that are both aesthetically appealing and inclusive to the widest variety of users.

DO	DON'T	WHY
avoid flashing designs	design flashing content	Flashing content is known to cause seizures in users with photosensitive seizure disorder.
Option 1 Option 2 ensure active elements are large enough to activate	Option 1 Option 2 overlap or demand precision to interact with active elements	People with conditions such as cerebral palsy, Parkinson's disease, and arthritis have limited fine motor skills and may struggle to activate elements in small target areas.
create responsive designs	limit designs to one view	Responsive design prevents horizontal scrolling and reduces confusion for people with cognitive disabilities. It includes the use of large enough target sizes for people with limited dexterity.
build clean and consistent layouts on all page	build complex, cluttered, or a large variety of layouts	Lack of structural consistency will quickly confuse people with cognitive, learning, and neurological disabilities.